

Rough



Rough diamonds | Diamond crystals can be found in a number of external forms, all related to their cubic structure. Here, they have formed rough cubes.



Cullinan rough model | This is a model of the largest diamond ever found – the Cullinan (see p.53). It weighed 3,106.75 carats and was the size of a potato.

Thick carbon inclusions



Carbonado | This specimen consists of carbonado, a distinct cryptocrystalline variety of diamond originating from Brazil and Central Africa.

Tip of octahedron



Perfect octahedron | The majority of diamonds found are crystallized as octahedrons, as here. Originally, only the crystal faces were polished.

We had with us salted birds... we placed the gem on them, they became animated and flew away

Reference to diamonds in the Babylonian Talmud

Colours



Blue Heart Diamond | This natural blue diamond, cut into a heart shape, originated in the diamond fields of South Africa. It weighs 30.62 carats.



Brilliant cut | Looking downward through the table of this brilliant-cut diamond, the clarity of the stone and the reflectivity of its facets can be seen.

Crown facets



Brown diamond | Brown diamonds originate mainly from Australia, and, as seen in this pendalogue-cut gemstone, tend to lack the brilliance of diamonds in other colours.



Deep green | This green diamond has been cut into a pendalogue. Its intense hue suggests it may have undergone colour enhancement (see box, right).

Oppenheimer Diamond | One of the largest uncut diamonds in the world at 253.7 carats, this perfectly formed curved octahedron is a natural yellow stone.

Yellow colouring

